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DREAM MACHINE | Creative AI News & Insight { June 2026 - Issue 34 }



Pete Woodbridge ✓
Innovation Director | AI & Realtime Systems | Creative
Infrastructure | Future Production



June 16, 2026

Welcome to edition 34 of Dream Machine. Covering **AI in the Creative Industries**: Film, Music, Games, Media and Entertainment.

Created and curated by [DreamLab](#), a studio of artists, creative technologists, directors, games & software developers..... including Emmy winners, PhD researchers, and BAFTA-recognised talent. Find out more about how we are [empowering and amplifying creative work](#).

You can also listen to the [Dream Machine Podcast](#) 🎧 and for deeper insights and full on analysis, along with some predictions about where this is all heading... check out the [Dream Machine: Artificial Intelligence and the Next Creative Economy](#) Book



m Machine #36 | ComfyUI MCP + More News This Week from AI in

Preview Jul 2 · Dream Machine - Creative AI

Saved on Spotify

Editor's Pick: The AI World Cup — When Sport Becomes a Living Digital System



FIFA World Cup 3d Experience on the BBC

The 2026 FIFA World Cup is being positioned as the most technologically advanced sporting event ever staged — but the real story is much bigger than football. Across officiating, broadcasting, fan engagement, gaming, security and marketing, **AI is becoming the infrastructure layer powering one of the largest shared cultural moments on the planet.**

Every player entering the tournament is scanned for one second to **create a photorealistic digital twin**, generating 3D avatars that can support **automated offside decisions, immersive replays and new broadcast experiences**. Combined with sensor-enabled footballs, computer vision tracking and real-time rendering, the match is no longer just captured by cameras — it becomes **a live data model that can be analysed, visualised and recreated from almost any perspective.**

Behind the scenes, FIFA is also deploying AI as a competitive tool. A new football intelligence system gives all 48 nations access to advanced tactical analysis, **allowing coaches to query millions of data points around opponents, player performance and match patterns**. The bigger experiment is whether AI can genuinely democratise elite-level insight — giving smaller football nations access to the same analytical capabilities traditionally reserved for the biggest teams.

The biggest shift, however, is happening around the game itself. The World Cup is becoming **a multi-platform storyworld: broadcast feeds, AI-generated highlights, personalised content, Roblox experiences, creator channels and social media communities all built around the same live event**. Fans are no longer simply watching the tournament; they are **remixing, sharing and creating new versions of it in real time**. AI is accelerating that transformation by translating, editing, personalising and distributing content at a scale human teams could never achieve alone.

For the creative industries, the lesson is clear: the future of entertainment will not be a single piece of content distributed everywhere. **It will be a living ecosystem built around a central experience, with AI enabling infinite variations for different audiences, platforms and communities.**

The 2026 World Cup is not just a sporting event enhanced by technology — it is a glimpse of how the next generation of global entertainment franchises may be designed.

- [Watch live games, replays and highlights in 3D](#)
- Read our [Deep Dive into Creative Technology & AI at the World Cup](#)
- [Listen to the summary on the Dream Machine Podcast](#)



News

Video, Film, TV, Broadcast & Animation

- Runway and Lionsgate Expand Partnership [LINK](#) taking an Equity Stake in Runway AI [LINK](#)
- AI Firm Utopai Studios To Co-Produce Silver Bear-Winning Filmmaker Hyo-Joo Yang's Feature 'Half Moon' [LINK](#)
- AI Script-Analysis Start-Up Quilty Strikes Preferred-Look Deal With Giovanni Entertainment [LINK](#)
- Ron Howard Is Bullish on AI and Thinks Jim Henson Would Have Been Too [LINK](#)
- Gore Verbinski Says We Need a 'Rating System' for AI Use in Films: 'If You Use AI to Write a Script, You Get an F' [LINK](#)
- Emily Blunt refused Steven Spielberg's offer to use AI for her alien voice in 'Disclosure Day' [LINK](#)
- Steven Spielberg reveals the one thing he'd change about his movie A.I Artificial Intelligence today [LINK](#)
- A.I and Animation – A Call for Understanding [LINK](#)
- The future of Hollywood isn't feeding prompts into vanilla gen AI models, AI is so much more than that [LINK](#)
- Asteria And LTX Form Strategic Partnership With Goal Of Advancing Cinematic AI Storytelling [LINK](#)

Games, Immersive & Interactive

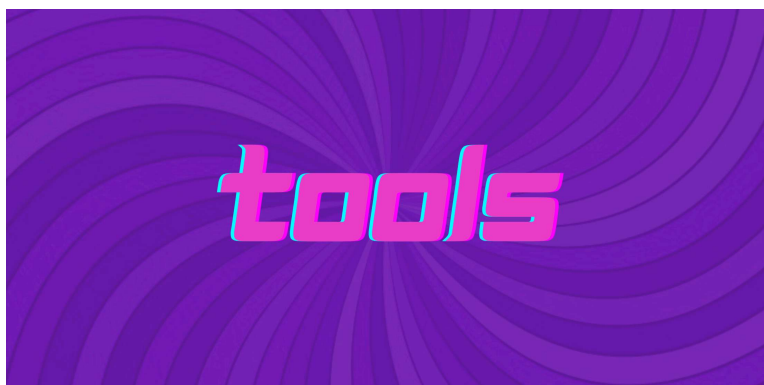
- Once again players are right to suspect AI was used in a game, once again a dev apologizes for using AI in their game [LINK](#)
- More than 300 games released on Steam last week, and 120 of them had AI disclosures [LINK](#)
- Roblox just acquired three AI research teams to solve the specific technical problems blocking photorealistic multiplayer worlds - Morpheus AI, Dynamics Lab, Lucid AI [LINK](#)
- After the full-scale invasion of AI, the gaming industry is panicking. [LINK](#)
- Does That Space Marine Have an Extra Finger? Yes, but Games Workshop Insists It's Not AI [LINK](#)
- Pokémon Go data trained AI that could assist military drones in war zones [LINK](#)
- ClarityQ launches game-native AI analytics platform for mobile game studios [LINK](#)
- Welevel unveils AI-based city-building survival game SolidRiver and \$8.5M in funding | exclusive [LINK](#)
- Niantic Spatial Denies Pokémon Go Data Is Being Shared With A Drone Company [LINK](#)

Music & Sound

- Legend Rick Rubin Is Hiring an AI Sensei for the Summer. [APPLY HERE](#)
- Deezer launches an AI music detector for other streaming services [LINK](#)
- Google Moves to Dismiss Artists' AI Lawsuit, Says They Consented 'To the Use of Their Recordings' When Uploading to YouTube [LINK](#)
- Lionel Richie Is Trademarking the Sound of His Voice: 'Hello, Is It Me You're Looking For?' [LINK](#)
- Warner Music Group Acquires AI Detection Company Sureel [LINK](#)
- Apple Music Gets a Huge Update in iOS 27 with Siri AI [LINK](#)
- NMFA unveils AI licensing deals with Udio and Klay with 50/50 split for songs and recordings [LINK](#)
- A fake AI album released in my name made me realise why the law needs to change [LINK](#)
- AI-Cloned Vocals Fuel Late Minnesota Rapper Eyedea's New LP [LINK](#)

More Creative & AI News

- AI hiring surges 'across all UK sectors', according to new findings from PwC, with a 34% salary premium for AI skills [LINK](#)
- The US government, citing national security authorities, has issued an export control directive to suspend all access to Fable 5 and Mythos 5 [LINK](#) Leading to Anthropic suspending frontier AI tools [LINK](#)
- Pioneering UK Nerve Lab harnesses AI to map effect of children's screen time [LINK](#)
- A recent study by MediaScience and Adelaide University found that AI disclosure labels have minimal effect on key metrics such as brand recall and ad sentiment. [LINK](#)
- N8N is doubling down on London, following other UK investment announcements in the last week including ElevenLabs, Lovable, Legora and Cursor [LINK](#)
- Played By Humans is verifying 'human artistry in an AI age' [LINK](#)
- AARON Signals 2026 Report Maps the Emerging Reality of AI Creativity [LINK](#)
- Fresh data from the Ramp AI Index shows the top 1 percent of firms now spend \$7,500 per employee per month on AI [LINK](#)
- [Anthropic](#) is going to teach 1,000 fellows how to master Claude, match them with nonprofits across America [LINK](#)
- **TacticAI**: Google's AI system that can help simulate field scenarios and predict open play dynamics up to 8 seconds in advance. [LINK](#)
- UK Regulator Introduces "World First" Controls on the Use of Content in Google Generative AI Features [LINK](#)



Tool Spotlight

Captions are auto generated

Generate Production Ready utility passes with ComfyUI

- VFX artist [@heydoughogan](#) breaks down a ComfyUI workflow that generates production-ready utility passes directly from your footage. [LINK](#)

Captions are auto generated

-
- VEED Fabric 1.0 - Create hyper-realistic AI explainers and educational videos (up to 5 minutes) in seconds [LINK](#)

NVIDIA SANA streaming

- NVIDIA's new SANA-Streaming brings high-resolution, real-time video-to-video editing to consumer GPUs. [LINK](#)

Introducing Avatars
ElevenLabs



Watch on

- ElevenLabs has launched Avatars in ElevenCreative. The best AI voices, now with a face. [LINK](#)

Pixelcut Background Remover in FAL

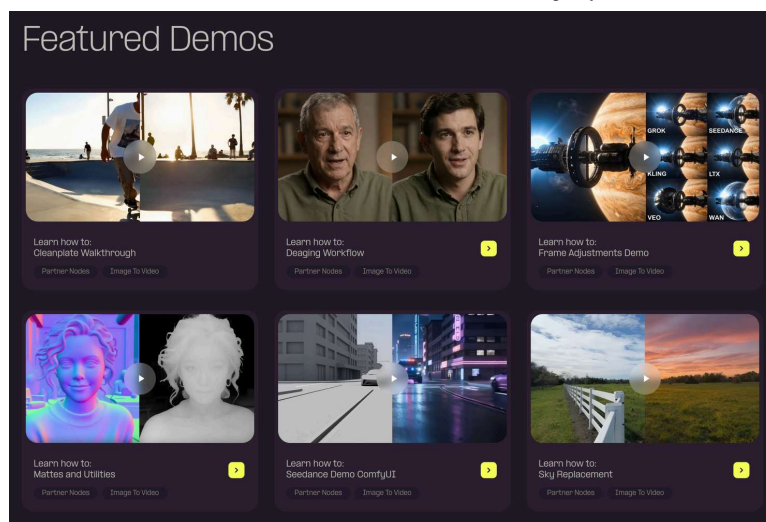
- Pixelcut Video Background Remover is now live on fal. [LINK](#)
- Wubble empowers creators generate ethically created royalty-free music, AI voiceovers, and sound effects from prompts. [LINK](#)

Learn How To: Face Swap
ComfyUI



Watch on

- De-aging and Face Replacment Demo in ComfyUI [LINK](#)



comfyui learning

- Want to learn ComfyUI, one of the most in demand skills in top agencies - here's some great tutorials covering VFX pipelines [LINK](#)

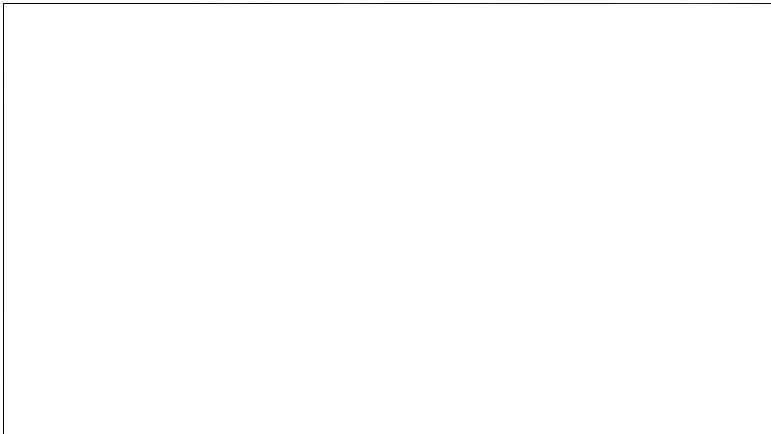
Tripo 8K Textures

- Tripo 8K Texture applies 8192×8192 detail directly onto 3D models, preserving surface fidelity without upscaling. [LINK](#)

Runway in ChatGPT

- Use Runway inside ChatGPT to generate and edit video and images. No tab-switching required. [LINK](#)
- Animotive Kimodo brings AI-powered text-to-animation directly into Unreal Engine. Now on the FAB Marketplace [LINK](#)
- MotionBricks from NVIDIA Research runs real-time character animation at scale, without hand-crafted transitions or fine-tuning. [LINK](#)

- ComfyUI - Turn one idea into a complete storyboard, then animate it in Seedance 2.0 using a reference image. [LINK](#)



HiggsField Games

- Higgsfield has introduced Higgsfield Games, a new system that promises to create and deploy multiplayer games from a single prompt. [LINK](#)

Fal's LTX2.3 Audio Reactive LoRA

- New open-source LoRA built in-house: LTX2.3 Audio Reactive LoRA. Built for music-driven video generation [LINK](#)
- Orchestria - an AI music engine with granular stem control [LINK](#)



Roboflow RF-DETR

- RF-DETR is a real-time transformer architecture for object detection and instance segmentation developed by Roboflow [LINK](#)

Introducing Hyper3D Rodin Gen-2.5: the Most Contr

Hyper3D Rodin



Watch on

- The world's first 10-million-polygon AI 3D model is here. Rodin Gen-2.5 generates 1 million polygons in 4 seconds and scales all the way up to 10M polygons with skin-level microstructure detail. [LINK](#)

Seedance Mini

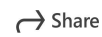
- Meet Dreamina **Seedance 2.0 Mini**: Built for quality and speed, at lower cost. [LINK](#)
- Open Generative AI — Open-Source Alternative to AI Video Platforms [LINK](#)

Next Time...

If you've got any recommendations, opportunities or news we need to know about for our next edition please feel free to reach out



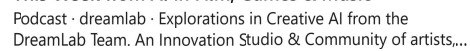
dreeeeeeaaaaammmmmmlabbbb!

Me



and here's the audio/podcast version for people on the move <https://open.spotify.com/show/2ptbLwVWeyO7ooPGHoYTqk?si=0d3592aefc0f4fba>



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Like | Reply | 2 impressions



Like | Reply | 89 impressions



